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Vol. I.

JUNE, 1894.

No. 6.

Published Monthly.

Dr. Courtney's Guide TO Happy Marriage.

Smallest Magazine in the World. Subscription price, 50 cts. per year. Single copies, 5 cents each.

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MARRIAGE GUIDE.

The Newly Wed.

We will suppose you have read and profited by the excellent suggestions contained in an article published in a previous issue of this library, under the head of “How to Woo, Win and Wed.” You have succeeded in winning the object of your affections, and have set sail upon the sea of matrimony. It is often called a troublous sea. Such indeed it proves in truth to be for those who embark upon it not fully prepared for the voyage. Do you really, married or unmarried, know the full meaning of the word marriage. It is something far more serious than a mere civil contract or religious ceremony. These are only the marks of outward show. There is a good deal behind these—a good deal that you ought to know, and of which, perchance, you are ignorant. The aim of this article is to give some practical advice to those who have already entered into the bonds of matrimony, and it will not, it is hoped, come amiss to those about to marry, but who have not yet taken the step that leads to misery or bliss. “Marriage,” says Selden, “is a desperate thing; the frogs in Æsop were extremely wise; they had a great mind to some water, but they would not leap into the well, because they could not get out again.” Would that most of us possessed the wisdom of the fabled frogs.

Purpose of Marriage.

Marriage ought to be consummated as the result of mutual love and esteem, and not for the purpose of simply gratifying the desires of our lower nature. This last consideration is, it must be acknowledged, a controlling one with a great many people, and marriages contracted in this manner are not generally, and cannot hope to be, happy ones. The sacredness of the marriage relation ought never to be violated. We must not forget that we are rational beings with a will to withstand the weaknesses of our animal natures.

Happy and Unhappy Marriages.

A happy marriage is without doubt the ideal state of living, the end for which mankind has always striven, while an unhappy marriage is a veritable hell on earth. Examples of both of these states need not be given. We see them every day. To one who reads the daily papers regularly with particular note of the records of divorces, assaults of drunken or jealous husbands, the faithlessness of women and the elopements, the thought must present itself that there are more unhappy marriages than happy ones. This, fortunately, is not true. Where we read of one unhappy marriage and its terrible consequences there are ten happy ones of which the world never hears.

“Marriage,” writes Addison, “enlarges the scene of our happiness and miseries.”

“It is a mistake,” says another writer, “to consider marriage merely as a scheme to happiness; it is also a bond of service, it is the most ancient of that social ministration which God has ordained for all human beings, and which is symbolized by all the relations of nature.”

Still another writer says: “Married life appears to me a sort of philosophical discipline, training persons to honorable duties, worthy of the good and wise. Few unmarried people are affected as they ought to be toward the public good, and perceive what are really the most important objects in life.”

How to be Happy.

Those who wish to lead happy married lives cannot do better than to follow a few rules which we present herewith.

Husband and wife ought to maintain entire confidence in each other, have no secrets each from the other; don't quarrel; have forbearance for each other's failings; you have neither of you married an angel. Remember, husband, that of every dollar you own, fifty cents belongs to your wife; she is an equal partner with you in the business of life; don't compel her to become a mere household drudge, working for her board and clothes; she did not marry you for that. Try to see the good points of your husband or wife; don't magnify the faults; we are all only human; don't have the first quarrel and the second will never come.

Golden Precepts.

Let the rebuke be preceded by a kiss.

Don't require a request to be repeated.

Never should both be angry at the same time.

Be lovers all your life. Let the courtship be continued after marriage.

Never neglect the other for all the world beside.

Let each strive always to accommodate the other.

Let the angry word be answered with a kiss.

Bestow your warmest sympathies in each other's trials.

Criticize as little as possible, but if you find it necessary to criticize, make your criticism in the most loving manner possible.

Make no display of the sacrifices you make for each other.

Never make remarks calculated to bring ridicule upon the other.

Never deceive; confidence once lost can never be wholly regained.

Always use the most loving and gentle words when addressing each other.

Let each study what pleasure he can bestow upon the other during the day.

Always leave home with a tender good-bye and loving words. They may be the last.

Consult and advise together in all things.

When you feel like quarrelling, discuss the whole thing together and you will come to an amicable settlement.

Never reproach the other, especially in the presence of others, for an error which was committed with a good motive and with the best judgment at the time.

Don't tell your friends the faults of your husband or wife.

The Duty of the Wife.

The wife's place is in the home. That is her proper sphere of action, and the one in which she ought to be most happy.

Don't devote time to society matters while your house duties need to be done. Don't spend your time in making clothes for some naked boys in Dooloboo who do not need them, while your own children go about with patched or torn clothing.

Greet your husband with a smile on his return from work.

Don't scold your husband.

Don't think your husband ought to be perfect. Are you yourself perfect?

Be careful and economical in the expenditure of money for household purposes. (By the way, your husband ought to make you the treasurer of the firm.)

Always dress neatly for your husband's sake. You used to do it before marriage. Imagine your husband is still your lover.

Treat your husband's friends politely. This is an important part of your wifely duty.

Don't spend money extravagantly for dress or other personal adornment.

The Husband's Duty.

Don't think the woman you have married is yours, body and soul.

Don't be niggardly in money matters.

Don't withhold from your wife your tender love and sympathy. Regard her as your dear sweetheart all through life. Always treat her with tender consideration.

Don't try to argue with her. A woman cannot reason; she is guided rather by her womanly intuition, which is rarely at fault.

Follow the counsel of your wife. Many a man has done so and succeeded. Wisdom and foresight are possessed by women, as well as men.

Let your wife understand fully your business. Don't let her think you are earning fifty dollars a week when you are earning only thirty dollars, or vice versa.

Give your wife all the pleasure you can. She needs it.

Do not go about enjoying yourself with boon companions while your wife toils at home.

Don't spend money for rum while your wife has to make over her old dresses.

If your wife is worthy of it (most wives are), praise her. Women like praise.

Women are not as strongly built as men, and are thus likely to be often in delicate health. If so, your wife may be petulant and cross. Make allowances for this and don't scold her.

Don't interfere with your wife in the performance of the duties that belong peculiarly to her.

Give her money enough to dress well, even if you have to make sacrifices to do so.

Treat her mother with becoming respect.

Marrying for a Home.

A good many women are foolish enough and dishonorable enough to marry merely for a home—foolish because they cannot expect such a marriage to result happily, and dishonorable because they have deceived the man they married. Love ought to be the basis of all marriages.

Joy and Pleasure.

A married life is not one of unalloyed bliss. We ought not to expect this. It has its pains as well as its pleasures. As Margaret Fuller says: “Deceive not thyself by over-expecting happiness in the marriage state; look not therein for contentment greater than God will give, or a creature in this world can receive, namely, to be free from all inconveniences. Marriage is not, like the hill of Olympus, wholly clear without clouds.” When misfortune comes to us, and all the rest of the world deserts us, we have those at home to whom to look in certain expectancy of sympathy and encouragement—wife and children. As John Taylor says: “A married man falling into misfortune is more apt to retrieve his situation in the world than a single one, chiefly because his spirits are soothed and retrieved by domestic endearments, and his self-respect kept alive by finding that, although all abroad be darkness and humiliation, yet there is a little world of love at home over which he is monarch.”

A married man is more apt to labor for the good of all mankind, while a single man is apt to be more selfish in his aims and endeavors. The interests of a single man centre round himself, while those of a married man embrace his whole family, and in a larger degree the whole community.

Don't Board.

If you are a newly-married couple, don't board. Go to keeping house as soon as possible. Don't get married if you can't do this. A young woman ought to learn the duties and pleasures of housekeeping as soon after marriage as possible. If she boards out, she has little to occupy her time, and is apt to pass her days in reading silly novels, or to fall into that terrible habit of gossiping. She ought to find pleasure in working for her husband, and she can work for him best only in her own home, preparing his meals and by the performance of other wifely duties. As a mere boarder in somebody else's home, she cannot do this. There are many drawbacks and perplexities about housekeeping, to be sure, but these ought to be met and contended with with a brave spirit. In the end, having conquered, it will be found that the pleasures far outweigh them. A woman ought to take pleasure in looking after the home nest, and ought not to leave to some unsympathetic boarding-housekeeper the task of preparing the daily meals for her husband.

The Mother-in-Law.

A mother-in-law is often a blessing, but few will admit the truth of this statement. Many men, however, have found her to be a ministering angel in disguise. It is better, nevertheless, for the newly-married couple to live by themselves, if possible, and not be under the sway of a mother-in-law, or other relative, however kind and unselfish she or they may be. They ought to strike out for themselves. A mother-in-law, however good her intention may be (and no doubt her intentions are always good), is pretty sure to prove meddlesome and dictatorial to a greater or less degree, and end by being an element of discord in what ought to be a happy home. You will find it better to paddle your own canoe, even if you do not make very rapid or easy progress at first.

Marriage a Lottery.

Marriage has been called a lottery. Fortunately it is a lottery in which there are a great many prizes. Let us give you this bit of advice in regard to marriage as a lottery: Try to think that you have drawn a prize. Thinking so will go a good way toward making the supposition a pleasant reality. Never lose sight of this fact. If your husband or wife does not come up to the high standard which you have hoped for, try to stifle the disappointment. It might be worse. Start out well on the sea of matrimony. "Many a marriage," writes Frederika Bremer, "has commenced like the morning, red, and perished like a mushroom. Wherefore? Because the married pair neglected to be as agreeable to each other after their union as they were before it. Seek always to please each other; lavish not your love to-day; remember that marriage has a morrow, and again a morrow." Another writer on the same subject wisely says: "The happiness of married life depends on a power of making small sacrifices with readiness and cheerfulness. Few persons are ever called upon to make great sacrifices or to confer great favors; but affection is kept alive, and happiness secured, by keeping up a constant warfare against little selfishness."

Jealousy.

It is said that jealousy is an unmistakable sign of true love. We are supposed to be jealous of those whom we most dearly love. There may be some truth in this assertion, but we incline rather to think that it is open to dispute. Only the weakest are the most jealous. But the “green-eyed” monster has caused too much misery to treat the matter lightly. Where mutual love and respect and perfect confidence exist, and where the married parties are sensible, intellectual people, jealousy rarely exists. Jealousy, such as that which is said to be an infallible sign of true love, is exhibited chiefly by silly young women, married and single, who have no serious grounds for suspicion against the object toward which their jealousy is directed. If you are of an incurably jealous disposition, never marry any one of the opposite sex who is good looking. This will only add fuel to the fires of your jealousy. Marry a homely person—the homelier the better—one who is not likely to receive undesirable attentions from the opposite sex after marriage. But the best advice of all is don’t be jealous. Be sensible. Nine times out of ten you have no real cause for jealousy after all. To be jealous of your husband or wife implies that you have married a partner who cannot be trusted. Have you married such a person? Probably not. Then why be jealous?

Mental and Physical Exercise.

People in ill health cannot be expected to be happy whether they are married or single. In order to preserve the health of mind and body, the laws of health, as regards pure air, exercise, food, drink, etc., must be rigidly followed.

Exercise is one of the best means of preserving health. Care must be taken, however, that the exercise be of a kind and amount suitable to the needs of each person. Recreation, or a change of occupation (but never idleness), is sufficient exercise for some people. But there is little recreation in a game of chess, for instance, in the case of a man employed in a counting-room all day. His exercise should be taken out of doors, and be such as to free the mind from the exactions of business. The wealthy idler will find health in industry of some kind. Horseback riding is beneficial for those engaged in sedentary occupations, such as bookkeeping, office-work, etc. Walking is the best kind of exercise of all, and the most easily obtainable. Bicycle riding, too, is very good; so are all open-air games when not indulged in to excess. Dancing is an agreeable and healthy recreation for those engaged in sedentary pursuits. Indeed, it is considered second to none. One of the worse cases of consumption has been known to have been cured by dancing, practised daily for many months. Horseback riding is also very good for consumptives. Swimming is one of the best kinds of exercise.

All but babies have too little sleep. Everybody ought to get at least eight hours' sleep in a day. Insanity often results from want of sleep. Always sleep on the right side, never on the back. Always breathe through the nose when asleep or awake. Never have a fire in your sleeping-room, unless you are an invalid. The need of cleanliness, pure air, pure water, sunshine and a cheerful disposition, etc., are too well known to need insisting upon here. These are necessary for the preservation of health, and without health there can be no real happiness.

The Art of Ventriloquism.



This great book was written by the celebrated Frederic Maccabe, one of the most famous of the world's ventriloquists. Mr. Maccabe here clearly shows that ventriloquism is not a natural gift, but that by training and practice it may be acquired by any one, and it is certainly an accomplishment well worth cultivating, for nothing will so amuse and mystify a social gathering as the feats of the ventriloquist. He appears to be a man of a dozen voices. In his natural tone of voice he asks a question, and the

answer appears to come from the depths of the chimney in the weak accents of a little child. Again, we hear the voice of an old man appearing to proceed from the roof of the building, the distant barking of a dog, etc., etc. These wonderful imitations are performed without the slightest movement of the lips, greatly to the astonishment of the audience. Would you not like to acquire this amusing and mystifying accomplishment? You can do so easily and readily by studying the directions contained in this book, which is the best and most complete instructor in the art of ventriloquism ever published. It is a book of 64 large, double-column pages, bound in attractive

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HIS LEISURE MOMENTS.

5. Give him to understand that manners make a good substitute for morality.
6. Teach him to expect pay for every act of helpfulness to others.
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